

Make it easy to refer me

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What I do (one line)

I find what's actually slowing a founder's team down — and in one 90-minute session they stop scaling around it. They leave knowing what to stop, and the one move to make instead.

Who it's for

Founders or CEOs with a real business and one consequential decision they cannot get an independent read on. They have tried a reasonable fix, the result contradicted their explanation, and the next 30–90 days will commit meaningful money or team capacity. Once the call is clear, they can act.

The moment to refer them is after the first fix failed and before the next hire, build, reorganization or quarter scales the workaround. Funding stage can make the stakes larger; it is not enough by itself.

The phrases to listen for

These are real things founders have actually said, not invented copy. You'll know it's a fit when you hear something like:

- "My team is slow" / "My team feels slow."
- "Something's been slow for months and I don't know why."
- "I thought doing more would fix it — it just made things worse."
- "I feel lost all the time, 24 hours isn't enough."
- "I can't see the north star I used to have."
- "I get sweaty every time I think about spending more."
- "I don't know if I can scale right now — I'm more scared of what happens after than the decision itself."

They don't need to say it exactly. The pattern is: the same decision still blocks delivery after one reasonable fix, and another operating cycle will make the mistake more expensive.

Who it's NOT for

- People without a live costly decision or authority to act on it
- People who find the problem *interesting* but not *expensive* (no urgency, no budget)
- Anyone shopping for motivation, done-for-you implementation, or a general advisor

A pattern worth naming: when it keeps coming back to the founder

The clearest referral moment isn't a first complaint, it's a *second* one. Someone around the founder already tried a reasonable fix — a new planning tool, a tighter weekly meeting, clearer roles, a senior hire, another attempt to delegate. It didn't hold. The next exception, priority call, or stalled handoff still lands back on the founder's desk, because a process can't carry authority nobody assigned, and a hire can't close priorities the founder keeps reopening.

Refer when all five are true:

- the founder or CEO runs an operating company with customers or a team;
- one consequential decision will shape the next 30–90 days;
- the current drift has a concrete cost in rework, reversal, delay or missed revenue;
- a reasonable first fix has already failed; and
- the founder has the authority and demonstrated ability to act on the finding.

Pass when the business is still an idea, the question is general, nobody can name the cost, or the founder expects someone else to do the implementation for them.

How to introduce me

The forwardable line:

"My friend Trung finds what's actually slowing early startup teams — 90-min session, and you walk out knowing what to stop scaling around. If that sounds like someone you know: [linkedin.com/in/ctn1991](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ctn1991). DM him 'diagnostic' to start."

Or just send them my LinkedIn ([linkedin.com/in/ctn1991](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ctn1991)) and tell them to DM diagnostic. They'll figure out if it's relevant.

One thing worth knowing about the relationship

Not every conversation ends in a diagnostic sale — and that's fine. When it's not the right fit, Trung says so directly and the relationship holds. People who don't buy now often come back months later, or refer someone who's a better fit. You won't burn a relationship by introducing someone: if it's not the right time, the conversation will be useful anyway and the door stays open.

What you get back

This goes both ways. Tell me who *your* ideal client is and what to listen for — I'll send them your way when I

hear it. No fees, just trust running both directions.

Live version: iamtrung.com/d/partner-one-pager